James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Content and search operator with eight years in marketing, five of them at B2B software companies. I build content programs from zero, write the anchor pieces myself, and tie the work to pipeline. I have led a team of writers and editors to thousands of ranked keywords in a crowded software category, built an AI-assisted search content engine that lifted non-branded organic traffic 48%, and run webinars, a podcast and a newsletter. I use Claude and my own tools to research, draft and check every claim, including an open source tool that tests which brands AI assistants name. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/vcluster.

Selected Achievements:

- Led a content team of five writers and two editors at Distrobird, a sales engagement software company: **3,000+ keywords ranked in three months**, **500,000 monthly search impressions** and **4x content output**.
- Built Reform's AI-assisted search content engine: **100x content output** and **48% more non-branded organic traffic**. Competitor pages brought **19% more decision-stage leads**, and integration pages **28% more organic sessions**.
- Built a quarterly demand generation program at FunnelEnvy across content, lifecycle and paid: **40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads**. Planned and hosted the first webinar and ran the YouTube and podcast operation.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**, writing every issue on a review-gated AI production workflow.
- Generated **1,646 marketing qualified leads, 629 demos and $3.4M in open deal value** as Chief Revenue Officer at Cecure Intelligence Limited, running sales and marketing as one team.

KEY SKILLS

Content Strategy: Editorial Calendars, Thought Leadership & Executive Bylines, Webinar & Podcast Programs, Customer Stories, Content for Account-Based Programs, Research-Led Content

Search & AI Answers: SEO Audits & Roadmaps, Competitor & Integration Pages, Answer Engine Optimization (AEO), AI Referral Measurement, Prompt Panel Testing, llms.txt & Structured Data

AI-Native Production: Claude Code, Review-Gated Content Workflows, Repurposing One Asset into Ten, Claim Verification, n8n Automation

Tools: GA4, Google Search Console, Ahrefs, Semrush, DataForSEO, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, HubSpot, Webflow, WordPress

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate, including product showcases for software companies.
- Built the publication's production system in Claude Code: a four-phase writing workflow with review gates, and automated distribution across LinkedIn, X and Instagram.
- Built and published an open source AI answer visibility audit tool that runs a fixed set of buyer prompts and records which brands each AI assistant names.
- Built 82 marketing agent skills for my own work, 34 of them published on GitHub.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Built an AI-assisted search content engine producing 100 articles a month: 48% more non-branded organic traffic and a 22% domain rating gain.
- Built competitor pages (Typeform, Jotform) and integration pages: 19% more decision-stage leads and 28% more organic sessions from integration pages.
- Repositioned the product around lead conversion and rebuilt the landing pages: 34% lift in trial activation.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across content, outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.
- Planned and hosted the first webinar (41 registrations, 29% attendance) and ran the YouTube channel and podcast with former clients as guests.
- Launched the newsletter at a 48% average open rate and built a content workflow that turns one asset into ten or more pieces.

Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024
Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)

- Built the inbound content program from zero and led five writers and two editors.
- Ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months, reaching 500,000 monthly impressions and 5,000 organic clicks in 90 days.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function from scratch across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer, running revenue operations and cross-functional GTM teams.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads and 629 demos: $3.4M in open deal value.

Product Marketing & Growth Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech and consumer brands

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across four countries): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0